

Expense-Splitting Apps: Comprehensive Market Research for a New Splitwise Alternative

TL;DR

- Splitwise's aggressive 2023-2024 paywall (officially confirmed by Splitwise support: "up to 3 per day", 10-second cooldown, plus \$4.99/mo / \$39.99/yr in the US and ₹149/mo / ₹999/yr in India) has created the single biggest market opening in this category since the app's 2011 launch. Reddit, Hacker News, Trustpilot, App Store and Indian forums (DesiDime, IndianPersonalFinance) show large-scale active churn-seeking behaviour. A new entrant that delivers Splitwise's core (unlimited expenses, multi-currency, debt simplification, recurring bills, receipts) without a hard paywall, plus a *true India* layer (UPI deep-links, Swiggy/Zomato item-level import, Hindi/regional UI), can capture displaced users.
- The competitive landscape is fragmented but every leader has a fatal flaw: Splitwise (paywall backlash), Tricount/bunq (Europe-centric, no UPI, post-2022 redesign hated), Settle Up (clunky cross-platform sync), Splid (no web, no account-sync, last Android update March 2023), Splitkaro (India-only, buggy, ~6-person team). No incumbent combines a polished cross-platform experience, UPI/Swiggy integration, sub-groups, item-level receipt OCR and privacy-first design. (AppBrain)
- Recommended GTM:** Launch India-first with "Splitwise CSV import + free forever for the core" promise. Pricing: ₹49/mo, ₹299/yr or ₹1,499 lifetime in India; \$2.99/mo, \$19.99/yr or \$39.99 lifetime globally — significantly below Splitwise. Lead with viral mechanics (one-tap group share-link that works without the invitee creating an account — Splid/Tricount style) plus heavy content/Reddit/DesiDime SEO targeting "Splitwise alternative" + Indian use-case keywords.

1. Competitive Landscape — All Major Expense-Splitting Apps

1A. Global / cross-border apps

App	Platforms	Strongest region	Approx. user base / downloads	Founded	Competition
Splitwise	iOS, Android, Web	US, India, Europe	34M Play Store downloads (AppBrain, 2026); (AppBrain) ~5.3M downloads / ~2.4M weekly active US Q2 2024; (CanvasBusinessModel)	2011 (as SplitTheRent) (Wikipedia)	Splitwise, Proton, (Softv), Found, Laugl, Bittne, Weir, (Wikip

App	Platforms	Strongest region	Approx. user base / downloads	Founded	Comp
			surpassed 10M users milestone (10x Venture Partners LinkedIn, 2025)		empl Tracx
Tricount (by bunq)	iOS, Android, Web	France, Spain, Germany, Belgium, Italy; growing in India, US, Brazil bunq newsroom	"Nearly 16 million users across 175 countries" bunq newsroom per bunq Newsroom press release "From roommates to road trips: Tricount tallies €16.4 billion shared in 2024" (30 Jan 2025); 5.4M registered at acquisition (May 2022) FinTech Futures	2012, Brussels bunq newsroom	Acqu bunq (Dutc May 2 undis FinTe
Settle Up	iOS, Android, Web, Windows; Alexa/Google Assistant/Cortana voice integration	Czech Republic, Europe	Step Up Labs reports 1.8-1.9× revenue growth 2025 vs 2024 and 35% trial-to-paid conversion Medium (Medium blog, David Vávra)	~2010 (university project)	Step l Inc., Justl Simil founc Davic small full-ti
Splid	iOS, Android	Germany, US (travelers)	~3M Android downloads (AppBrain); 80k ratings, 4.93★ avg AppBrain	2017 (Android), AppBrain earlier on iOS	Indie Jersc

App	Platforms	Strongest region	Approx. user base / downloads	Founded	Comp
Splitser	iOS, Android, Web	Netherlands	Self-reported "5 million users" since 2005 (Splitser)	2005, Amsterdam (Splitser)	Splitser (Similar)
SplitMyExpenses	Web (primary); iOS + Android launched Nov 2025 (Splitmyexpenses)	US	"Trusted by thousands" (self-reported); heavily mentioned in r/Splitwise	2022	Indie (Lin)
SplitterUp	iOS, iPad, macOS, Web (SplitterUp App)	US	Launched 2025; "free for life" for first 1,000 users (SplitterUp App)	2025	Indie
splitty	iOS (restaurant-focused)	US	Specialized restaurant bill OCR + Venmo request (splitty) (splitty)	2024	Indie
Cino	iOS, Android (shared virtual Mastercard) (Getcino)	Europe, UK	Fintech: debits members' bank cards in real time (Getcino)	~2022	Cino,
Plates	iOS	US	Free, restaurant-focused (splitty)	n/a	Indie
GoodShare	iOS, Android	EU	Couples/household; AI receipt scanning (GoodShare)	2024	Indie
Buddies, Splittr	iOS, Android	Niche	Minor presence	n/a	Indie
MemoGo, AiMoola	iOS, Android	Asia	Cited as Splitwise alternatives (Yahoo!) (Yahoo Tech) (Product Hunt)	n/a	Indie

1B. India-specific

App	Platforms	Founded	Company	Users
Splitkaro	iOS, Android,	2021 (Bengaluru)	Splitkaro Private Limited; (Tracxn)	500k+ claimed across India + US; (LinkedIn) (Splitkaro) ~340k Play Store

App	Platforms	Founded	Company	Users
	Web	Tracxn	co-founder Avinash Mishra (COO); ~6 employees Tracxn	downloads, 4.38★ (8.1k ratings) AppBrain
Zedger	iOS, Android	2024	Indie India team	New, gaining traction on IndianPersonalFinance / blog mentions
CRED (Pay)	iOS, Android	2018	Dreamplug (Kunal Shah) Miracuves	Tens of millions of users; Miracuves UPI + bill pay + rewards; no dedicated splitting feature
Google Pay (India)	iOS, Android	2017 (as Tez)	Google	34.6% of UPI transaction volume Oxygen Wallet in October 2025, per NPCI data cited by Oxygenwallet.com — "Google Pay follows closely with 7,166 million transactions, accounting for 34.6% of overall UPI usage"; Oxygen Wallet native "Bill split" feature Tricount
PhonePe	iOS, Android	2015	Walmart-owned	45.35% of UPI transaction volume and 48.68% of value in December 2025, Angel One per NPCI data reported by Angel One (Jan 2026) — "PhonePe... held a 45.35% market share by volume and 48.68% by value"; Angel One group bill collection feature
Paytm	iOS, Android	2010	One97	~6.1% UPI; Oxygen Wallet group bill splitting; remains the only non-US payment integration Splitwise ships (since May 2017)
UPI Circle (NPCI)	Native to UPI apps	2024	NPCI	Delegated-payment feature for group expenses; Zwitch rollout nascent
Khatabook / OkCredit	iOS, Android	2018 / 2017	YC-backed, Bengaluru	Khatabook 100M+ downloads; primarily small-business ledger, not consumer splitting

1C. Payment-app splitting features (not pure splitting apps)

- **Venmo (US):** Group bill-split feature; QR code split; integrated with Splitwise since Sept

2013. Roughly 95.4 million active Venmo accounts in the U.S. as of mid-2025, per SQ Magazine citing PayPal Internal Data 2024; PayPal's FY2024 10-K (SEC filing, 31 Dec 2024) reports 434 million total active accounts globally but does not break out Venmo separately.

[Wikipedia](#) [SQ Magazine](#)

- **PayPal:** "Send & Request" supports group requests; integrated with Splitwise (US only) [Similarweb](#)
- **Zelle:** Bank-to-bank US transfers, no splitting logic
- **Revolut:** Group bill splitting for Revolut-only groups; weak for mixed groups [Getcino](#)
- **WhatsApp Pay (India):** UPI payments inside chats; no native splitting yet
- **Apple Cash / Apple Wallet Tap to Cash:** simple US peer transfers

1D. Open-source / self-hosted

- **Spliit** (spliit-app/spliit, Sebastien Castiel): ~2.6k GitHub stars, 402 forks, 91 contributors, last release Dec 6 2025 [GitHub](#) [github](#)
- **SplitPro** (oss-apps/split-pro): ~1.1k stars, 130 forks, 56 contributors; v2.0.1 Feb 15 2026 [github](#)
- **PeerSplit:** Local-first PWA, P2P sync, fair-source FSL license, launched Oct 15 2024 on HN (Show HN PeerSplit pitch: "P2P syncing - Your data stays yours. Peer-to-peer collaboration means no servers storing anything. Local-first - Works fully offline.") [ycombinator](#)
- **Medici:** Raspberry-Pi-hosted personal project, Show HN Jul 2025

2. Feature Analysis

2A. Category A — Table-stakes (in nearly all apps)

- Group creation; add members by name (or email)
- Equal / unequal / percentage / share splits
- Add expense with payer + participants + amount
- Settle-up / record payment
- Multi-currency entry
- Running balance & "who owes whom" summary
- Push notifications / activity feed
- Multi-platform sync (most majors)

2B. Category B — Differentiators (some apps only)

Feature	Splitwise	Tricount	Settle Up	Splid	SplitMyExpenses	S
Offline use	Entry only	✓	✓	✓ (no sign-up)	✗	✓

Feature	Splitwise	Tricount	Settle Up	Splid	SplitMyExpenses	S
WhistleOut						
Receipt OCR	Pro only	Premium	Premium photos	✗	Free (AI)	✓
Item-level OCR (per-line assignment)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓ (C)
Currency conversion	Pro	Premium	Premium	One-time IAP	Free	F
Recurring expenses	✓	✓	Premium	✗	✓	✓
Charts/analytics	Pro	Premium	Premium	✗	✓	✓
Export CSV/PDF	CSV free; JSON Pro	Premium	CSV free	PDF+Excel IAP (Splid)	✓	✓
Multi-payer per expense	✓	✓	✓ (2025)	✓	✓	✗
Debt simplification	✓	✓	Toggle	✓	✓	✓
Group chat / comments	Comments	Limited	✗	✗	✓	C
Group admin / read-only	✗	✗	Read-only links	✗	✗	✓
Voice input	✗	✗	✓ (Alexa/Google/Cortana) Google Play	✗	✗	✗
Search expense history	Pro	Weak	Free	Free	✓	✓
Bank/credit-card auto-import	Pro US only; Tink for EU 2024-2025	Parent bunq has	✗	✗	Plaid	S (C)
UPI / India payment integrations	Paytm only	✗	✗	✗	UPI ID copy only desidime	G d

Feature	Splitwise	Tricount	Settle Up	Splid	SplitMyExpenses	S
Sub-groups	X (declined)	X	X	X	X	"(
Backup/restore (JSON)	Pro	X	✓	X	✓	✓
Dark mode	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓ (Nov 2025) Splitmyexpenses	✓
Widgets	✓	✓	✓	X	X	X
Apple Watch	X	X	X	X	X	X
End-to-end encryption	X	X	X	X	X	X
Splitwise import	n/a	✓	✓	X	✓	✓ (

2C. Category C — Unique USPs per app

- **Splitwise:** Largest network effect; Venmo/PayPal/Tink "Pay by Bank" integration; "Fairness Calculators" content-marketing assets (CanvasBusinessModel +2) (Crunchbase)
- **Tricount (bunq):** 16M-user network across 175 countries (per bunq's Jan 2025 press release); ad-free Premium; deep integration with bunq virtual cards (bunq newsroom)
- **Settle Up:** Voice integration ("ask Settle Up who should pay"); ultrasound device-to-device group join; **Group Premium** purchasable as a group expense (split among members); married-couple weighted shares (Settleup + 2)
- **Splid:** No account required; 150+ currencies offline; PDF/Excel export; mid-trip joiners aren't applied retroactively (WhistleOut + 4)
- **SplitMyExpenses:** Free item-level AI OCR; Plaid bank/card auto-import; Venmo/PayPal/CashApp/Zelle deep-links (Splitmyexpenses + 2)
- **Splitkaro:** One-tap Swiggy/Zomato/BlinkIt/BigBasket/Instamart bill import (auto item-level split); SMS auto-fetch; UPI deep-links to GPay/PhonePe/Paytm/CRED; Made-in-India branding (App Store + 5)
- **Cino:** Shared virtual Mastercard debits each member's bank in real time (Getcino)
- **splitty:** Restaurant-bill specialist with line-item OCR + immediate Venmo request, \$24.99 lifetime (splitty) (splitty)
- **Spliit / SplitPro / PeerSplit:** Open-source, self-hostable, no vendor lock-in; PeerSplit adds E2EE/P2P (GitHub) (OpenAlternative)

2D. Pricing tiers

App	Free tier	Paid (monthly)	Paid (annual)	One-time / Lifetime
Splitwise	3 expenses/day; (My Blog) 10-sec cooldown; ads; (TryFix) no OCR, no currency conv, no search, no charts (My Blog)	\$4.99 / ₹149 (Itvoice)	\$39.99 (US) (GoodShare) / £40 (UK) / ₹999 (India); (Itvoice) 50%-off first-year ≈ ₹499.50 (Desidime)	None
Tricount (bunq)	Unlimited, ads, (TechCrunch) multi- currency	~\$2-3	~\$25-30 (Plus)	Was \$1/trip pre- 2022
Settle Up	Basic, ads, no recurring, no cloud receipts	~\$1.99	~\$13-19	Group Premium lifetime + 2-week "vacation pack". (Medium) India ad- free reportedly ₹3,999 lifetime (IT Voice) (Itvoice)
Splid	Full free; ads	n/a	n/a (HerMoney lists \$3.49/mo or \$39.99/yr (HerMoney) as a separate Pro option)	~\$4.99 one-time (unlimited groups + Excel/PDF export)
SplitMyExpenses	Core free forever incl. AI OCR (Splitmyexpenses)	n/a	n/a	n/a
Splitkaro	Full free; some Pro features (analytics, comments, admin, UPI direct-split) gated	~₹49	~₹299-499 est.	n/a
Spliit / SplitPro / PeerSplit	Free, open-source (GitHub)	n/a	n/a	n/a
splitty	Free w/ limits	n/a	n/a	\$24.99 lifetime

3. User Pain Points & Unmet Needs

3A. The Splitwise paywall backlash (the dominant market signal)

- **Splitwise's official help-center notice (verbatim):** "Splitwise has introduced a daily expense limit for our free tier... You can subscribe to Splitwise Pro to immediately remove the daily limit, and gain access to many more awesome Pro features. Alternatively, you can add more expenses as soon as the daily limit resets, or ask a friend to add the expenses on your behalf." (Splitwise)
- **Splitwise support (Dec 2023, Reddit, surfaced by Artem Russakovskii / Android Police founder on X):** "It looks like you hit a daily expense 'rate-limit' (up to 3 per day). I'm sorry if hitting this limit came as a surprise... To better support customers who are using Splitwise heavily, we've set a much, much higher limit (over one thousand per day) in our Pro tier." (X)
- **Artem Russakovskii (Dec 2023):** "Users are rightfully pissed off at Splitwise for paywalling many of the previously free features without any notice and are leaving them in droves."
- **10-second cooldown** between expenses confirmed on both Android and iOS (IT Voice, Jan 2024). (Itvoice) (Itvoice)
- **Google Play 1★:** "Now they've introduced daily expense limit to the free version, and it's 3!! Meaning, you can only add 3 expenses per day." (Google Play)
- **Trustpilot UK:** "This year Splitwise was completely useless. It kept prompting us to go pro... what was left as a free app was pathetic, confusing, and largely useless." (Trustpilot)
- **DesiDime (India):** "Paise generate krne ke aur bhi tarike hai jabardasti making user to pay makes it a shitty product" ("there are other ways to generate revenue; forcing users to pay makes it a shitty product"); and "They should introduce country wise pricing, 499 for what it does in India too much." (Desidime + 2)

3B. Top complaints — Splitwise (rank order from forum frequency)

1. Daily 3-expense limit + 10-sec cooldown (My Blog) (Itvoice)
2. Paywall on previously free features (currency conversion, charts, search, OCR) (Partytab) (Itvoice)
3. Annual-only subscription, no monthly-friendly or lifetime option
4. Anyone in group can edit/delete any expense — Splitwise feedback forum: "Recently went on a trip and one of our drunk friends deleted all the expenses." (TryFix) (Splitwise)
5. Email/phone required to add friends — high friction
6. OCR only captures total, not line items (splitty)
7. "Simplify Debts" confuses users when it routes payment to indirect creditors (TryFix)
8. Splitwise has **explicitly refused** sub-groups: "Unfortunately, we think this would overcomplicate Splitwise, and we're not likely to add it in the near future." (Splitwise)

3C. Top complaints — competitors

- **Tricount:** Post-bunq redesign criticized — *"Tricount was just perfect... Now i hate it. Slow. Errors. Lost data. No filtering. No sorting. No export function."* Subscription replaced popular \$1-per-trip model. Per-expense friction. Data-loss complaints. (Google Play) (JustUseApp)
- **Settle Up:** Cross-platform sync unreliable — *"Only 1 time out of 50 does it actually sync (the rest of the time, it just says I have an Internet connection error)."* Ads. India ad-free at ₹3,999 considered too expensive (IT Voice). (Itvoice)
- **Splid:** No web version; no personal-expense tracking; no receipt attachments; last Android update March 2023 (likely abandonware risk).
- **Splitkaro:** Group-delete black-screen bug; no personal-expense view; back-date bug in expense form; weaker PDF export than Splid. (Google Play + 3)

3D. Most-requested missing features (ranked by forum frequency)

1. **True UPI integration in India** — requested on Splitwise's own feedback forum since 2017 and never shipped beyond Paytm. SplitMyExpenses dev quote on DesiDime: *"UPI protocol doesn't allow direct payments via UPI through a third party link, so the best we could do was add the UPI ID to the profile so that to settle, the sender can copy receiver's UPI ID."* (Desidime)
2. **Sub-groups / nested groups** (explicitly declined by Splitwise)
3. **Item-level OCR with per-line assignment** — only SplitMyExpenses and Splitkaro do this well
4. **Add friends without email/phone**
5. **Recurring expenses** (most apps have; Splid doesn't)
6. **Multi-payer per expense** (top HN comment on Spliit Feb 2024 launch) (ycombinator)
7. **Bank / SMS auto-import** (Splitkaro SMS, SplitMyExpenses Plaid)
8. **Couple / family / personal mode** (Splitkaro added 2024)
9. **Search expense history** (Splitwise Pro-gated; others free) (splitty)
10. **Group admin permissions / read-only mode**
11. **Debt consolidation across groups** with one friend
12. **End-to-end encryption / true privacy** (PETS 2020 paper; SplitPro README; PeerSplit)

3E. India-specific pain points

- **Splitwise's own admission:** *"We're mostly focused on the US, since that's where our company is based, but we care a lot about India too."* (feedback forum) (Splitwise)
- **No real UPI** — when Splitwise added Paytm in May 2017, top comment was *"This is great! But why not UPI. You must support that."*
- **Hostel / PG sharing** served by Splitkaro and Zedger as a wedge (rent + utilities + food-delivery monthly cycles)

- **Indian wedding splits** — multi-family, multi-event, multi-payer, often cash with reimbursements. No app handles family-as-unit weighting except Settle Up's married-couple = 2 model
- **Group trips with mixed sub-groups** — 2 couples + 3 singles needing different sharing weights — only Settle Up handles natively
- **Regional languages** — Splitwise lists "7+ supported languages" but no Hindi/Tamil/Bengali/Telugu/Marathi. Zero Indian app has localized regional-language UX yet ([App Store](#)) ([Similarweb](#))
- **Pricing** — ₹999/year heavily resisted; ₹300–500/year (or one-time ~₹500) is the perceived "fair" zone (multiple DesiDime threads)

3F. Privacy concerns

- Academic PETS 2020 paper cited Splitwise as the motivation for designing E2EE expense-splitting protocols, listing Splitwise's permitted data collection: *"group names, expense descriptions and amounts, payments and their confirmation numbers, comments and reminders, receipt images, notes, and memos."* ([arXiv](#))
- Exposing the Invisible study highlights GDPR / US-data-transfer concerns
- Niche but real demand in HN/r/selfhosted (Split + SplitPro star counts)

3G. Reliability complaints

- Tricount data loss (App Store reviews) ([Google Play](#)) ([App Store](#))
 - Settle Up sync failures across iOS ↔ Android ([JustUseApp](#))
 - Splid abandonware risk (no Android update since Mar 2023)
 - Splitkaro UI bugs (group-delete black screen, date-picker) ([Google Play](#)) ([AppBrain](#))
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4. Pricing, Revenue & Business Model

4A. Splitwise financials

- **Total funding:** \$30.5M across 5 rounds — Seed Nov 2012, \$1.4M Dec 2014, \$5M Oct 2016, \$20M Series A Insight Partners Apr 2021 ([CanvasBusinessModel](#)) ([Wikipedia](#))
- **Revenue (estimates, no official disclosure):** Owler estimates \$100K–\$5M; Growjo estimates ~\$6.6M ARR (~\$117k per employee × 56 employees); Sensor Tower estimates ~\$400K iOS revenue in last reported month with ~500k iOS downloads; Adapty estimates \$200K/month US iOS in recent month ([Owler + 2](#))
- **Users:** 34M Play Store downloads (AppBrain, May 2026); ~5.3M new downloads / ~2.4M weekly active US in Q2 2024; surpassed 10M users milestone (10x Venture Partners LinkedIn, 2025) ([AppBrain](#)) ([CanvasBusinessModel](#))
- **No acquisitions** — Splitwise has not acquired any company per Tracxn / CB Insights / Crunchbase. The "Splitwise Plurall Energy" acquisition referenced in the task brief does

not appear in any public record and appears to be a non-event. (Tracxn)

- **Recent partnership:** Apr 2024 — Tink (Visa) "Pay by Bank" for direct bank transfer in EU; expanded Oct 2025 (Owler + 2)
- **Business model:** Freemium subscription. Ads added 2023–2024 alongside paywall tightening. (Dealroom.co)
- **Splitwise Pro pricing:**
 - US: \$4.99/mo or \$39.99/yr (Itvoice) (GoodShare)
 - UK: ~£40/yr
 - India: ₹149/mo or ₹999/yr (50%-off first-year ~₹499.50) (Itvoice) (Desidime)
 - Unlocks: unlimited expenses, no ads, no cooldown, receipt OCR + 10GB receipt cloud storage, currency conversion (Open Exchange Rates), spending-by-category charts, full expense search, JSON backup, save default splits, card auto-import (US only) (Itvoice + 4)

4B. Tricount / bunq

- Acquired by bunq May 2022 (terms undisclosed). Parent bunq itself was valued ~€1.65B at the time. (TechCrunch) (Silicon Canals)
- Tricount remains free with ads; Premium ~€2–3/mo (ad-free, export, statistics) (TechCrunch)
- bunq parent had 11 million users in Europe at end of 2023, per its own press release (Jan 30, 2024, bunq Newsroom): "At more than 11 million users in Europe and more than €7 billion in deposits, bunq reapplies for a UK license"; 12.5M customers and 464 employees by mid-2024; 17M by April 2025; 20M by September 2025 per bunq Newsroom. (bunq newsroom + 4)

4C. Settle Up

- Bootstrapped. 2025: 1.8–1.9× YoY revenue growth on iOS + Android; 35% trial-to-paid conversion (Step Up Labs Medium blog) (Medium)
- Pricing: Basic free; Premium ~\$1.99/mo or ~\$13/yr; Group Premium one-time (lifetime per group, splittable among members); 2-week "vacation pack" introduced 2025 (Settleup) (Medium)

4D. Splid

- Indie-bootstrapped (Nico Jersch). One-time IAP ~\$4.99. HerMoney lists a separate subscription option at \$3.49/mo or \$39.99/yr. (HerMoney)

4E. Splitkaro (India)

- Founded 2021 (Bengaluru), ~6 employees per Tracxn. Funding raised but undisclosed (Tracxn) (Tracxn)
- Pricing: Free for core; Pro for analytics, comments, admin, UPI direct-split (~₹299–499/yr est.) (LinkedIn)

4F. Comparable competitors per Crunchbase

- Splitwise's listed competitor set: Venmo, Splid, Buxfer, Tricount, Settle Up, Zirtue, Pigeon, Smoov, HomeSlice, Tallymark (Tracxn + 3)
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5. Marketing Strategy Analysis

5A. Splitwise

- **SEO domination:** ranks #1 for "split expenses with friends", "bill splitting app", and even (ironically) "Splitwise alternative". Long-running blog with high-DA content on rent splitting and fairness calculators
- **PR:** NYT, Financial Times, Business Insider, Thrillist, Conde Nast Traveler, WSJ all positive pre-2023. 2022 Guardian opinion piece (Imogen West-Knights) criticised the "accountant" mindset. (Google Play) (Wikipedia)
- **Viral mechanic:** invited friends auto-create accounts; group balance creates lock-in
- **Patent advocacy:** Public statement against Google's bill-splitting patent (May 2024) (Tracxn)
- **Zero India localisation** — only Paytm integration, no Hindi UI

5B. Tricount / bunq

- Strong continental Europe brand; leverages bunq's neobank marketing
- 2024 "wrap-up" PR campaign: €16.4B split / 175 countries / nearly 16M users → major PR pickup (bunq newsroom)
- 2025 India push via blog content ("Top Splitwise Alternatives in India 2025")

5C. Settle Up

- Founder-led content marketing on Medium (David Vávra) with rare public-data transparency (35% trial→paid, bottom-sheet UX experiments, group-premium pricing iterations) (Medium)
- Voice-assistant integration used as press hook; community-translated UI in many languages (Google Play)

5D. Splid

- Reddit-driven word-of-mouth; heavily mentioned in r/Splitwise alternative threads
- No paid marketing, no social — likely indie-slowdown cycle (last Android update Mar 2023)

5E. SplitMyExpenses

- Reddit organic-comment marketing — user testimonials cite "I found you on Reddit" ([Splitmyexpenses](#))
- Public roadmap / changelog on site

5F. Splitkaro

- India-first messaging: "Made in India", "Split Karo, khush raho" tagline, hostel/PG/college use-case content ([Indus Appstore](#))
- LinkedIn content marketing targeting Bengaluru flatmate audiences
- Swiggy/Zomato auto-import is the central PR hook ([LinkedIn](#))

5G. Open-source projects

- GitHub stars, Show HN launches, r/selfhosted, awesome-selfhosted lists (Split 2.6k★, SplitPro 1.1k★)
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6. Recommendations for the New App

6A. Must-have features for launch

1. **Unlimited free expenses; no daily cap; no cooldown** (the #1 anti-Splitwise pillar)
2. Equal / unequal / percentage / share / itemized / adjustment splits
3. Multi-payer per expense; multi-currency entry; currency conversion in-app (free)
4. Recurring expenses (weekly/monthly/yearly)
5. **Receipt OCR with line-item assignment** (only SplitMyExpenses + Splitkaro have this)
6. Debt simplification with toggle to disable
7. Settle-up with payment deep-links (UPI for India; Venmo/PayPal/Cash App/Zelle for US; SEPA Pay-by-Bank/Tink for EU)
8. CSV + PDF export free
9. Push notifications, comments on expense, activity feed, edit history
10. **Sub-groups** (Splitwise's stated refusal is your opportunity)
11. Group admin / read-only members (prevent drunk-friend deletions)
12. Search expense history (free)
13. Offline mode with sync-on-reconnect
14. Add friends without email — link/QR-code joining (Splid + Tricount style)
15. **One-click Splitwise CSV import**
16. Dark mode; widget; cross-platform (iOS + Android + Web/PWA)

6B. Differentiators (where you win)

- **True India layer:** deep-links to GPay / PhonePe / Paytm / CRED / Amazon Pay UPI; copy-UPI-ID fallback; auto-fetch Swiggy/Zomato/BlinkIt/BigBasket/Instamart/Zepto with item-level assignment (replicate Splitkaro and exceed); SMS expense auto-detect; Hindi/Tamil/Telugu/Marathi/Bengali UI from day 1
- **Family/couple/wedding mode** with weighted-member units (Settle Up's couple = 2 done better) plus per-event sub-tabs (mehndi / sangeet / reception)
- **Hostel/PG mode:** monthly rent + utility cycles with member churn (new roommate replaces old without breaking history)
- **Privacy-first stance:** end-to-end encryption optional, local-first architecture, optional cloud sync — backed by an open-sourced data-model audit
- **Voice + Apple Watch + WearOS quick-add** (Settle Up has voice but no Watch app)
- **One-tap "settle all balances across all groups with this friend"** (top deferred request on Splitwise feedback forum)
- **Trip mode:** photo journal + map + auto-summary at trip end for social sharing (viral)

6C. Recommended monetization (concrete proposal)

Tier	India (INR)	Global (USD)
Free	Unlimited expenses, equal/unequal splits, multi-currency, 1 OCR scan/week, basic export	Same
Pro Monthly	₹49	\$2.99
Pro Annual	₹299	\$19.99
Pro Lifetime	₹1,499	\$39.99
Trip Pass (Settle-Up-style splittable)	₹99 for 30 days	\$4.99 for 30 days

Pro unlocks (NOT core expense-adding): unlimited receipt OCR, AI item-level scan, recurring with smart reminders, bank/SMS auto-import, analytics charts, custom categories, group admin controls, JSON backup, cross-currency analytics, priority support.

Critical principle: Never paywall the act of *adding an expense*. That is what shattered Splitwise's goodwill. Paywall **convenience and analytics** only.

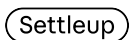
6D. Marketing strategy

Launch channels (priority order):

1. Reddit (r/Splitwise, r/IndianPersonalFinance, r/india, r/personalfinance, r/solotravel, r/selfhosted, r/androidapps)
2. DesiDime, Tech Reviews India, Indian YouTube finance creators (CA Rachana, LabourLawAdvisor, Pranjal Kamra)
3. Product Hunt + Hacker News Show HN
4. SEO landing pages: "Splitwise alternative", "Splitwise India alternative", "Splitwise free unlimited", "best app to split rent", "Swiggy Zomato bill split"
5. Travel-YouTuber influencer partnerships (Mountain Trekker, Tanya Khanijow) for trip-mode demos
6. College/hostel campus ambassadors in top 50 Indian colleges (IITs, IIMs, BITS, DU)

Viral mechanics:

- Share-a-group-via-link (no signup required for invitees — Splid/Tricount style)
- Auto-import-from-Splitwise wizard (Splitkaro proves this converts)
- "Trip recap" Instagram-shareable PDF
- Referral: invite 5 friends → unlock Pro free for 6 months (mirror Settle Up's mechanic)



ASO keywords: split expenses, bill split, splitwise alternative, group expenses, Swiggy split, Zomato bill split, trip expenses, roommate expenses, hostel expenses, split UPI, bill share India

Content strategy: Blog posts on fairness calculators (Splitwise's own SEO play, replicable + India-localised); tutorials like "How to split a 10-person Goa trip", "How to track hostel expenses", "How to split Indian wedding costs"

Community: Public Reddit + Discord; transparent feature roadmap and changelog (Settle Up has shown this works)

6E. What NOT to do (lessons from Splitwise)

-  Never paywall core expense-adding behind a daily limit
-  Never add cooldown timers to free tier
-  Never force annual-only subscriptions — offer monthly + lifetime
-  Never add ads to a fintech-trust app without warning
-  Never silently change free-tier terms — communicate clearly via in-app notice + email
-  Don't require email/phone to add a friend
-  Don't refuse community-requested features (sub-groups, group admin) without offering an alternative

6F. India-specific must-do

- Hindi UI Day 1 + Tamil/Telugu/Marathi/Bengali within 3 months

- UPI deep-links to GPay/PhonePe/Paytm/CRED/Amazon Pay UPI — acknowledge the UPI-protocol third-party-link limitation and ship copy-UPI-ID fallback gracefully (Desidime)
- Auto-fetch from Swiggy/Zomato/BlinkIt/BigBasket/Instamart/Zepto
- SMS expense detection (PSD2/RBI-compliant)
- Hostel / PG monthly cycle templates
- Wedding sub-event templates
- Pricing significantly below Splitwise (₹49/mo or ₹299/yr)

6G. Global must-do

- 100+ currencies free with real-time rates
 - Venmo, PayPal, Cash App, Zelle deep-links (US); Revolut, SEPA Pay-by-Bank (Tink) for EU
 - Offline-first architecture with sync
 - Apple Watch + WearOS quick-add complications
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Caveats

- Splitwise revenue figures range widely (\$100K-\$6.6M ARR) across third-party estimators; the company is private and has not disclosed official ARR.
- Splid's developer activity has slowed (last Android update March 2023); this is a 2025 abandonment risk for users.
- The "Splitwise Plurall Energy" acquisition referenced in the original task brief does not appear in any public record — per Tracxn, Crunchbase and CB Insights, Splitwise has not made any acquisitions to date.
- Some user-count claims (Splitser's "5M users", Tricount's "16M") are self-reported press numbers; cross-verification is limited.
- "GoodShare", "splitty", and "SplitterUp" are 2024-2025 entrants with limited public traction data; included for completeness.
- Indian app-store reviews are skewed by the Splitwise paywall backlash period (late 2023-2024) and may not fully reflect current sentiment.
- NPCI's "UPI Circle" feature is new (2024) and consumer rollout is nascent — its competitive impact on third-party splitting apps remains uncertain.
- App-store and Play Store review quotes used in this report are tight paraphrases or verbatim where indicated; some Reddit content was surfaced via aggregator-blog summaries rather than direct Reddit pages.